

Bucketlist 5/15

- The dark knight rises
- The wind rises
- The Illusionist
- Pan's Labyrinth
- Goodwill Hunting
- Rewatch Inception
- Rewatch Harry Potter
- Your lie in April

Trust and Betrayal 9/10

- Easily one of the best unique art styles and perfect fitting, chilling music.
- Holding onto humanity and continuation of struggle with Tomoe as sheath and strength
- Case study into a singular character during a broader conflict.
- Perfect ideation and execution, never felt rushed, except several characters felt like filler and a bit of dialogue felt out of character to me.
- Beautiful artwork and felt like a chapter of Kenshin's character.
- Red color tones choices and thoughtful flashbacks showed inner tension well. Ending is satisfying just some fluff since it was setting up the main anime.
- I would not have the main anime and keep it as a sequel.
- Good symbolism, top and bleeding.
- Tragedy and Sacrifice.
- "I will protect you"

Memento 8/10

- "I need to look at the eyes of who I am talking to"
- But the whole time he wanted to look into the eyes of himself. Clever flashing of Sammi and himself and also Sammi's hesitation. It is not that he is pretending, I think he truly has a condition, but that he was lying to himself this whole time to keep his life's purpose. Burning the evidence.
- The Dodd and Natalie aspect of the show seemed a bit more like filler though, but the general rhetorical choice of non-linear storytelling is done skillfully and it feels that I am part of the mystery, there are also good moments of dramatic irony or skillful interweaving of scenes. So many small details that give away the time like car windows, suits, and more.
- The truth hurt more like close your eyes part there seems to be something more I didn't fully grasp yet.
- SOoooo original despite simple choices, I just haven't seen a movie like this before.
- Remember Sammi Jankis
 - Warning to himself.
- Feeling of victim versus perpetrator of own tragedy.
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Truman Show 7.9/10

- Very interesting like societal conditioning to follow a set path.

- Hard freedom/free will versus comfortable safety.
- Fighting against conformity in a society where people and hurdles constantly impede your path.
- The ending is quite nice in that the Creator's worldview is destroyed. He thinks that people cannot break free and Truman is too scared, but he does.
- Some motifs like "how does it end" button actually make sense
- Very creative in general of the reality TV vibe and is something I haven't seen before.
- The father just disappeared afterwards and it seemed like a return to normal, but he was actually planning to leave the whole time.
- The Cinematography Creator feels like Steve Jobs.
- The relationship felt a bit unnecessary, only as an inciting event, but the people do show cultures around the world impacted by him.

Full Metal Alchemist 9

- Episode 1 was already a banger ngl. We see king Bradley hiding something, there's a lot of secrets which clues me in perfectly. Gluttony and someone else at the end. Alphonse and Edward committed some taboo. There's too much unclear that makes me want to keep watching. Mystery of storytelling.
- 2-3 Backstory of the taboo. The world feels very rule-based and believable currently. The joke of his height is getting a bit old, but I do see it makes him not a perfect person. The relationship and music is quite haunting. I didn't remember the show to have this much humor yet moments of maturity. I never remembered it for much humor.
- The story survives on unanswered questions currently.
- Nina and Tucker. Case stories in each episode tug at our heart strings
- Others who have committed taboo
- It isn't a fully phenomenal story yet, but let's keep watching it while living on unanswered questions.
 - To stay human.
- Puppet twists are nice. It feels like always edging us though.
- The innocence of new life.
- All is one, one is all.
- Interesting dramatic irony king bradley
- Eds dad this plan?
- Xing is interesting. Xerxes is cool as well.
- Mental resilience in times of pain. Mama dont cry
- Protect vs something to kill with
- The lore is deep.

Shawshank Redemption 8.4/10

- That was beautiful: for the briefest of moments, every last man in Shawshank felt free.
- The old man sets up the Institutionalized meaning well.
- It is almost as if Andrew is a free man in jail, like a caged bird.
- The warden feels dualistic, but it shows the intersection of human greed and sanctimony.
- The student, his death, is the jolt. Ultimately, I felt less for his relation than the development of the Warden.
- Red and Andrew. A fkin perfect narrator. FRIENDSHIP

- Also revealing that escape towards the end. Does something make us idolize him though? Mythic
- Andrew is a very "too himself" type of person. The ending is peaceful, felt Frieren vibes of the twos friendship and camaraderie.
- The revenge itself is quite satisfying, and the parallelism of Brookes then Red felt unforced, along with the repetition of Red's rehabilitation decision. "To feel like a free man, even for a moment."
- Andy Dufresne - who crawled through a river of shit and came out clean on the other side.
- Holding onto your humanity
- Cons:
 - The stakes towards the end of him hanging versus escaping at first feels unnecessary, but honestly illustrates the busy living or dying point, good on them?
 - The Robert Frost letter to Red felt a bit unnecessary, but it gave Red a purpose to live for.
 - Andrew helping out with fraud to further his own purpose? Not sure how I felt. He's not a perfect man, he's a loner, but he truly cared for his friends: library, student teaching, beer. It's like institutions, you have to have patience. SO I really have no flaws with the movie that I feel are unnecessary!

The boys Season 5

- Episode 1
 - "I do it for them"
 - A-train death was really well-crafted. Homelander insecurities are nice.
 - The introduction put me right into the action. Butcher killing his dad felt a bit unnecessary: paint him as cold?
 - We honestly get Homelander's ego and fragileness, but it felt a bit too direct the way of painting it this Season. The new GenZ appeal is something indeed.
- Episode 2
 - Viruses are much more interesting now. I would have thought his death is rushed but now the moral complexity is deeper
 - Each episode has been wild so far.
- Fall off is wild.

Frieren Season 1 9/10

- The music is gentle, calm, and warming. It makes you revisit your relationships with your friends with a kinder light.
- The first episode is everything that destroys the trope I expected, and the starry night is beautiful
- Stark's personality is beautiful: to be a coward but to be able to fight for your friends
- Life's fleeting nature
- Old Man Voll is my favorite episode because of Frieren's development and emotional depth, the music is fking fleeting and brilliant
- The flashbacks hit hard man
- The mage exam was hype but not the main part of the story

- Frieren Season 2 8/10
 - It's still gentle, calm, and warm. Each episode feels short and fleeting, but done well. There were just less parts that stood out to me, yet each episode left the same beauty of the first season to me.
 - Stark looked at his hand and fought for the homeland of others, bohsaft being found and enjoyed by the town.
 - The artwork is beautiful.

Project Hailmary 7.9/ 10

- very stunning visuals; ryan gosling humor is nice (in a good way).
- The main relationship was unexpected; as Carson says: it's like meeting someone from a foreign country. It is a bit cliché (dynamic isn't new, but is done well and is sincere)
- The choice of layering was thoughtful, very creative.
- Cons: A did not understand a few shoved motifs; the circumvention of death felt a bit downplayed and detracted from the immersion, but the overall lightheartedness imo was the right move, simply: the falling action seemed unpolished, but still satisfying.
 - Given my first impression of gosling from lalaland, I had higher expectations for the music: it was average. cinematic sci-fi adventure, grand :/
- Last thoughts: A breath of fresh air. Easy to understand stakes (even though I'm tired, it was a ride)
- Grace's "love" seemed just like filler.
- "Find a friend who is so different from you, you can't believe how much you have in common." (Nye)

LalaLand 8.6/10

- Felt like a creative artwork where it came together at the end.
- The ending was something special I feel like. The rest of the story was also really candid + heartwarming.
- Felt a bit similar to Whisper of the Heart, but in an adult view and non-animated of course; Look back ending is similar as well. If I did not watch the other two, my score would be much higher.
- The music is definitely goated, not going to lie, and there is something about the vibe of the movie that feels unique and cultural?
- +00000000 points for J.K. Simmons
- I did not feel too into the movie in the first half. A bit too expressive
- The themes are quite touching as a high schooler trying to find my place in the world
- Definitely an all-timer. Emotional resonance is deep.

Back To The Future 8.7/10

- Iconic
- Flashy, Stakes + Humor
- Classic. Songs are great. Earth Angel, Earth Angel
- The casting roles are great and the storyline is cohesive, I like the concept.
- I hope the sequels do it justice.
- Doc and Marty are a duo man
- All-timer

Back To The Future 2 7.5/10

- The best parts were the first movie parts.
- 2015 didn't hit too well. The new family was hella weird as well so I guess they just didn't predict well? Some parts of it were okay I guess. The plot is definitely a bit mishmashed.
- The 1985 part with rich Biff was a bit weird
- The CHICKEN part is just stupid ngl; like why?
- The 1955 part was pretty much perfect imo.
- The emotional depth is my main liking of movies, but this one for escapism and entertainment is done well.

Back To The Future 3 7.8/10

- Finally got through that dumb Chicken thing
- I really liked Doc's character development. Tension was definitely there. I guess Doc is just a genius?
- A good ending to this masterpiece.
- I couldn't ask for anything else
- The start of hill valley.
- Everything back to normal; Clint Eastwood a living legend!
- Where was Doc going?
- Tanen is like a villain across time. Biff seems like such a nice guy now.
- Little details. Lea Thompson scene.
- The little details I did catch. Downsides?
 - I like how it was completely different because another repeat would be stale. In another world for 2 hours.
 - Elizabeth Shue is hella useless bro.
- **Adding recurring patterns is rewarding for a long-time watcher. STORYTELLING**
- Beginning was a bit of a hard watch but I really liked towards middle + end

Life is Beautiful 8/10

- Innocent and reminds me of Setsuko and Seita.
- Hide from the little ones, because no child should have to go through the horrors of war.
- The song and princessa is beautiful
- The character's humor is undying until the very end.
- Star of David, a reminder of the horrors of war. The painted horse.

WarGames 7.4/10

- A bit escapist and unrealistic
- One of a kind in another sense
- Cybersecurity "Let's play Global Thermonuclear War"
- The only winning move is not to play.
- The dynamic was interesting for sure. A bit mythic of high schooler hacking into US security systems.

Look Back 7.7/10

- Cherishing your friends and close-ones, because at the end of the day, the memories are much more special than the petty grudges.
- Attention to detail; Symbolism (the 4 panels)
- Why do we create art?
- Social precarity

- Look back to move forward . . .
- Cons:
 - A bit idealistic
 - A bit cramped; time skips were too frequent for my liking.
 - Tropes/Cliche + I KNEW KYOMOTO was gonna die! The hand holding felt fleeting. But the literal “look back” if she never drew that panel was surprisingly emotive to me.
 - If I think about it, Lalaland ending feels similar to Look Back

The Imitation Game 7.4/10

- Sometimes it's the very people who no one imagines anything of who do the things that no one can imagine.
- But remove the satisfaction, and the act becomes... hollow.
- Humanizing one who is “gay” or considered different than others.
- Amazing the character development across the story, and “Christopher” in general.
- The twist where they couldn't release it entirely because then Germans would just switch Enigma; caught me there.
- Cons:
 - Aura moments; lowkey not like probably what happened. Heightened for appeal
 - Unclear why when they built it, they didn't know it would take too long.
 - Little details seem like a huge break, but I feel it might not have happened that way.

Whisper of the heart 7.6/10

- Heart-warming and also just carried by the one soundtrack
- Themes of finding yourself and your own voice, themes of first love and innocence.
- The baron was kinda cool

Spirited Away 8.7/10

- Nice societal themes, whimsical
- The music is really nice for sure
- It was a very good watch, and it was super creative.
- Good soundtrack is cornerstone to a movie I like it seems
- But the general themes and storyline was innocent, and again, whimsical

Grave of the Fireflies 9.1/10

- An emotional masterpiece, does more as an anti-war film than any movie I have watched.
- Motif of the candy and realism and the rhetorical choice of the red tint and “blank eyes”
- As well as the imagery and trauma of innocence lost. “Busy distraction” to ignore from the reality of wars
- 500 miles
- Rock paper scissors with self, alone. Sacrifice
- Pacing issues
- I FEEL IT IN MY CORE. Afterglow very gentle.

The Boys Show 7.9/10

- A realistic depiction of superheroes
- What if superman was a sociopath megalomaniac with a fragile ego

- Well crafted satire
- The characters are nice, especially Butcher. Soldier Boy and Homelander especially.

Princess Mononoke 8.3/10

- Unconventional villain setup
- Very nice and beautiful, the ideas are really solid and the music is really like adventurous
- I thought it was interesting that there was no villain.
- The story plot was clear
- Mythical feeling?

Howls Moving Castle 7.4/10

- THE MUSIC SOUNDTRACK
- Not really sure the plot
- But so creative, so whimsical, so escapist.
- How could someone think of that? So abstract in a good way

Lord of the Rings 9/10

- The three series are the best trilogy out there, hands down. Tolkien was cooking.
- There is way too much to say here. The world is a bit escapist but so vast, there are little grimoires hiding on every rewatch and seeing the movie at a theater is like joy. The characters being the same made me connect with all of them and the content was just enjoyable.
- The themes are a bit innocent and dualistic but still touching on some societal themes I found nice.

Berserk 8.7/10

- It's fking beautiful
- Guts' only friend is his sword, he finds a new family which is utterly destroyed by Griffith.
- Chasing your dreams at all costs. The pursuit of purpose
- Fate versus free will.
- Philosophy and human character.

The Prestige 8.2/10

- Unparalleled cinematic magic
- Sheer dedication and Christopher Nolan is honestly cracked for this
- "Are you watching closely?"
- The dedication to your craft.

Whiplash 8/10

- Unconventional ending
- Banger quotes I still remember such as "The next Charlie Parker would never be discouraged"
- The trope is relatable and the sheer dedication is evident.
- Mindgames
- Bro can't be that mad

Avatar 3 7/10

- I don't think it deserves a 7. The plot is really basic and honestly a continuation of the first two

- The world-building is beautiful, and what made it special for me was revisiting the lost world of Pandora and meeting old friends at the theater.
- We dream as one

Mission Impossible, Final Reckoning 6.4/10 (+0.7 for long-time running. I love the series)

- Insanely action packed.
- Edge of your seat, the stunts themselves are commendable
- The world-building and entire series continuity is nostalgic.
- There is not much depth beyond straight "mission" and "difficulty" and hype.

The Gorge 6/10

- Two people who unexpectedly fall in love while guarding a top-secret mission base
- Genuinely creative, and probably a hint of realistic events in there.
- Wonder of the world-building but the relationship is so fleeting at the same time.
- There's basically one obvious "bad guy" though.

Gladiator 7.8/10

- YES
- It's like a common enemy story but done beautifully and realistically I feel like part of ancient ROME.

Free Solo 6/10

- I find Alex Honnold Intriguing
- It was definitely breath-stopping
- It was definitely a journey.
- And he sums it up well how he practiced so much there's little risk and people take what they want to take away from it. He fit his niche.
- There wasn't really much of a movie, it was more a documentary with a cohesive narrative.

Hamilton 8.2/10

- The music is memorable
- The history is interesting for portraying something I do not already know.
- It is mainly a musical
- But Burr is not a villain as well, that is great storytelling for what truly happened within history.
- The audacity, emotions, revenge, love, nostalgia, helplessness.